*The famous German Surgeon General Esmarch (1823-1908) is considered to have conceived the idea of 'First Aid'.*

### 9.1.1 Definition of First aid

- First aid is simple medical treatment given the earliest possible to a person who is injured or who suddenly becomes ill.
- First aid is the initial assistance or treatment given to a casualty for any injury or sudden illness before the arrival of an ambulance, doctor or other qualified person. First aid is not an end by itself. It indicates that the person is in need of a "**Secondary Aid".**

### First Aider

The person who is trained to render emergency service on the spot until the medical aid is obtained is called a "**First Aider".**

### Qualities of a First Aider.

- Calm
- Confident
- Willing to offer assistance whenever neccessary

*A simple way to remember the aims of first aid is to think of the* **"Three Ps"**

***Preserve, Prevent, Promote.***

### Aims of first aid:

3Ps Preserve life

Prevent injuries /condition from worsening

Promote Recovery

### Scope of First Aid

The scope of first aid includes

a) Diagnosis

b) Treatment

c) Disposal of the case.

### (a) Diagnosis

Know the possible cause of accident or sudden injury.

Gather information from casualty and bystanders.

Watch for symptoms like faintness, bleeding, thirst, pain or shivering

Watch for abnormal signs like swelling, paleness etc.

### (b) Treatment

Remove the causative agent from the casuality eg. falling machinery, fire, electrical wire, poision etc.

### (c) Disposal

Arrange for the safe transportation of the casuality to the care of a doctor or hospital as soon as possible.

Inform the family or relatives at once.

## 9.2 Golden rules of first aid

1. Do first things first, quickly-quietly without fuss or panic.
2. Reassure the casualty through encouraging words.



Nursing-Gen_Chapter 09.indd 170 07/05/18 1:00 PM